

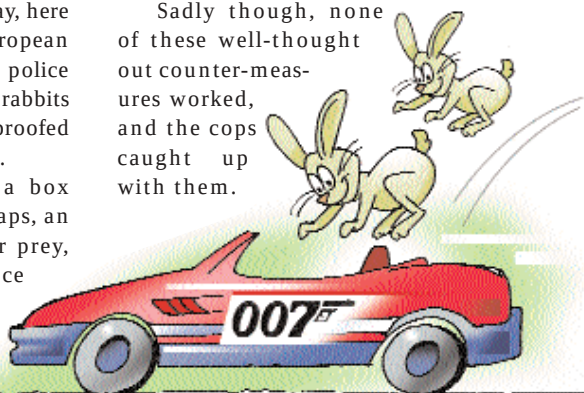
Not quite 007

Quick, what's common between James Bond and rabbit poachers in Belgium? Okay, here goes. Two rabbit poachers in the European nation were apprehended by the local police recently, after they whisked away 14 wild rabbits in, get a load of this, a steel-plated bullet proofed car à la Bond's Aston Martins and BMWs.

There's more. The vehicle had a box which could litter the road with tire traps, an external halogen lamp to blind their prey, and even lead shielding on the licence plates to avoid tracking. The top-rated gizmo was an ejector that could throw two bicycles fixed to the back of the car onto the

road as an obstacle to deter pursuers.

Sadly though, none of these well-thought out counter-measures worked, and the cops caught up with them.



Net's dark sin

A UK-based children's charity has revealed that child pornography is on the rise. NCH reveals that in Britain, such cases have shown an 1,500 per cent increase since 1998. It identifies only one reason—the Internet.

NCH's report, 'Child Pornography, Child Abuse and the Internet' pointed out that in 2002, 540 paedophiles were found in possession of pornographic material, or were warned by the police, as compared to 35 in 1998. It also exposed that offences committed in chat rooms have also risen dramatically. It has one more fear—the spread of 3G mobile services and phones, which they feel will allow users to transmit data and surf the Web without too much regulation or tracking.

Domain-nating times

The World Intellectual Property Organization has ordered Alberta Hot Rods, a Canadian company to give up the domain www.jrrtolkien.com, and return it to the estate that holds the intellectual property rights to all of the legendary author of *The Lord of the Rings* trilogy. The URL was linked to a commercial Web site www.celebrity1000.com.

This could happen because the UN arbitration system allows people to claim a domain name if they think they have the right to

own it, without paying large sums of money.

Though Tolkein died in 1973, his books are more famous now, especially after New Zealander



Peter Jackson created the *The Lord of the Rings* trilogy on celluloid. Alberta Hot Rods has already lost cases from famous personalities such as Pamela Anderson, Celine Dion and Carmen Electra.

No messaging on Palm?

Used to chatting on your Palm? OK, time to start worrying. Instant Messenger support for the Palm OS is being cut, one-by-one. First, it was Yahoo! Messenger, which stopped working with Palm in 2002, and now ICQ doesn't work—they recently changed their network. All

complaints to ICQ are being replied to with an irrelevant letter that says, "Since new wireless devices are constantly being released, each with their own unique technology, ICQ cannot test ICQ for Palm on each such wireless device." The only option left for Palm users is the AOL



heroes

Linux user community

Standing united against the SCO's IP rights campaign, a group of companies, led by IBM and Intel, is now setting up a \$10 million legal defence fund to help pay for possible litigation costs of corporate users of Linux.

Indian Consumers

With recent budget cuts, it's now cheaper than ever to buy computer hardware and electronics. Cell phones may be the cheapest in India—cheaper than Singapore—and complete PC prices will come down by 10 to 12 per cent.



zeroes

DDR2

Intel's pushing the Prescott processor family, and for DDR2 adoption. However, the limited number of suppliers, and the current price differential between DDR and DDR2, means that the chances of mainstream DDR2 adoption this year are slim.

Red Hat Linux 7.x and 8.0

Both these distributions have reached their errata maintenance end-of-life period. Users who expect support for these versions of Red Hat Linux will have little option, but upgrade to a newer release, or pick the Enterprise release.

snapshot

Web-ad spend to hit \$6.9 billion in 2004

Source: TNS Media Intelligence/CMR

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